

Orange County Public Schools: Anatomy of a 155-Year-Old District

From 1869 to today — an operational analysis of one of the largest school districts in the US: 207,000 students, 214 schools, 23,000 employees, and a \$3.8 billion budget, across academics, workforce, and community partnerships.

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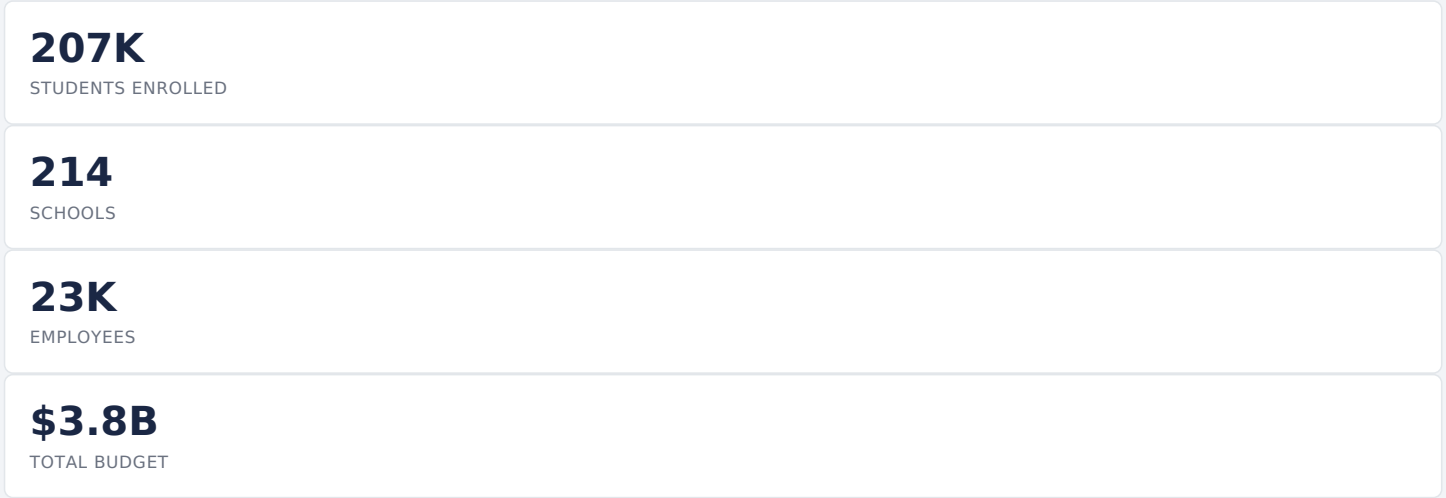
Tool: Power BI · DAX

Scope: 1869–2024

Role: Data Analyst

214 schools · 207K students · 23K employees

Original model & theme design



01 · Overview

A district the size of a mid-sized city, run like one

Orange County Public Schools has grown from its 1869 founding into one of the largest school districts in the United States: 207,000 students across 214 schools, a \$3.8 billion annual budget, and 23,000 employees — nearly matching the population of a small city, on staff alone. This analysis covers five operational layers: the district overall, the schools themselves, academic programs, the after-school community-partner network, and the workforce (including Orlando Technical College, a separate workforce-training institution the district also runs).

The district posts a 92.7% graduation rate for 2024-25, and in the sampled school-grade data, 36 schools earned an A, 35 a B, and 12 a C — no D or F schools appear in that sample.

RECONCILING THE NUMBERS

The district-wide KPIs (214 schools, 207K students) and the schools-detail dashboard (83 "Schools Open," 98K "Total Enrolled (Sample)") are not the same population — the schools view is explicitly labeled a sample, likely traditional public schools only, excluding charters, adult/technical campuses, or other school types folded into the district-wide count.

WHAT SURPRISED ME

The after-school program isn't run by the district alone — 109 sites across the district are operated by 6 different provider organizations (Boys & Girls Club, City of Orlando, the district itself, Orange County Government, the US Dept of Education, and the YMCA), funded through five distinct channels: city government, county government, a federal grant, a nonprofit, and the district's own budget. A K-12 school system is, in practice, also running a small multi-agency social-services network.

Key takeaway: "The district" isn't one organization operationally — it's a hub coordinating city, county, federal, and nonprofit partners simultaneously, at least for after-school care.

02 · Approach

The analyst workflow behind this report

This project follows a standard data-analyst pipeline:



- 1. Ingest** — district-level data spanning enrollment history (1869-2024), school-level demographics and grades, academic program enrollment, after-school provider partnerships, and workforce/OTC records.
- 2. Analysis & visualization** — five dashboard pages covering the district overview, schools, programs, after-school partnerships, and workforce — covered in Section 03.
- 3. Reporting** — this document.

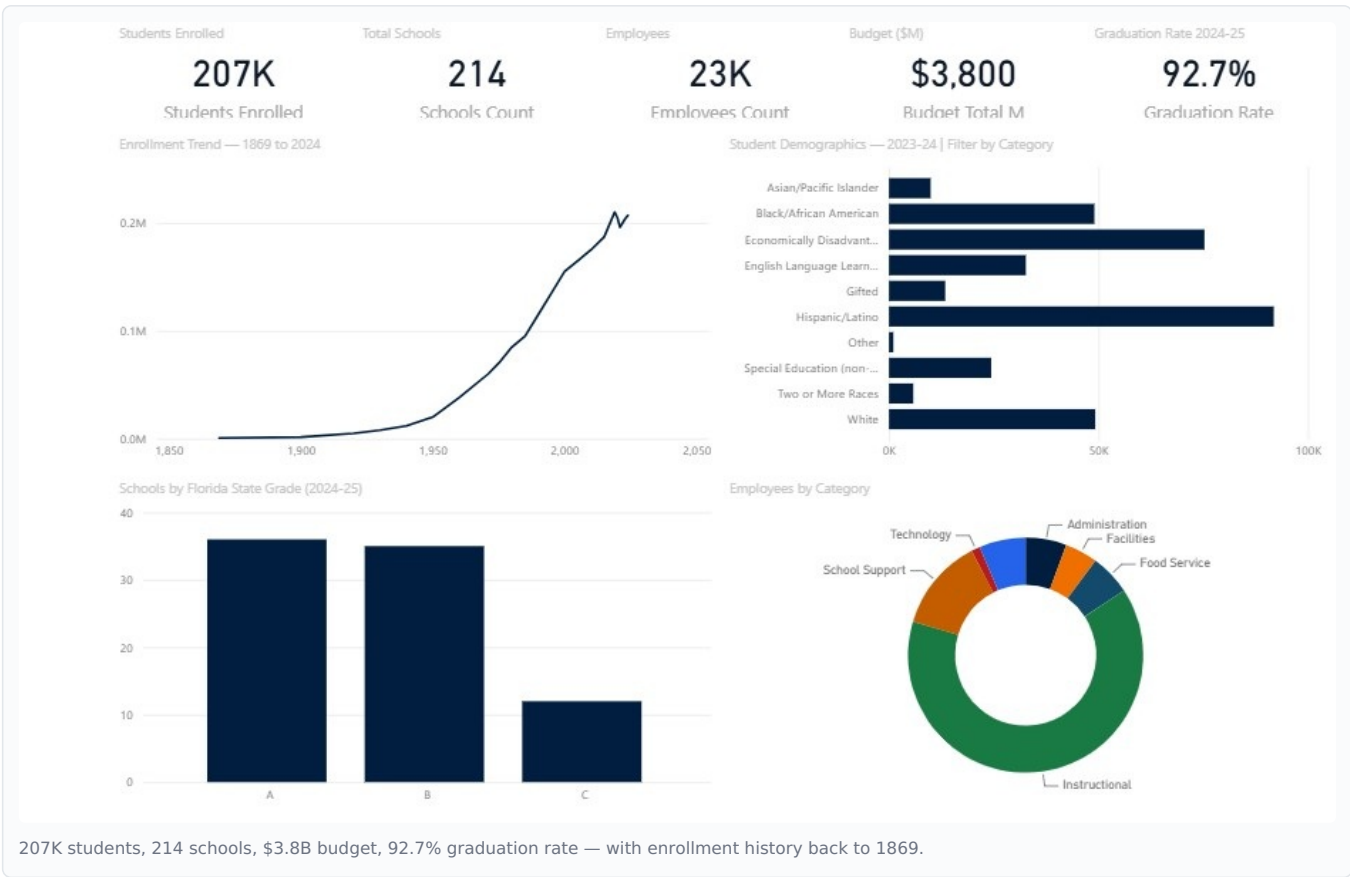
This report's design system was built by me as part of this analysis — not a default template.

03 · Insights

Five layers of one district

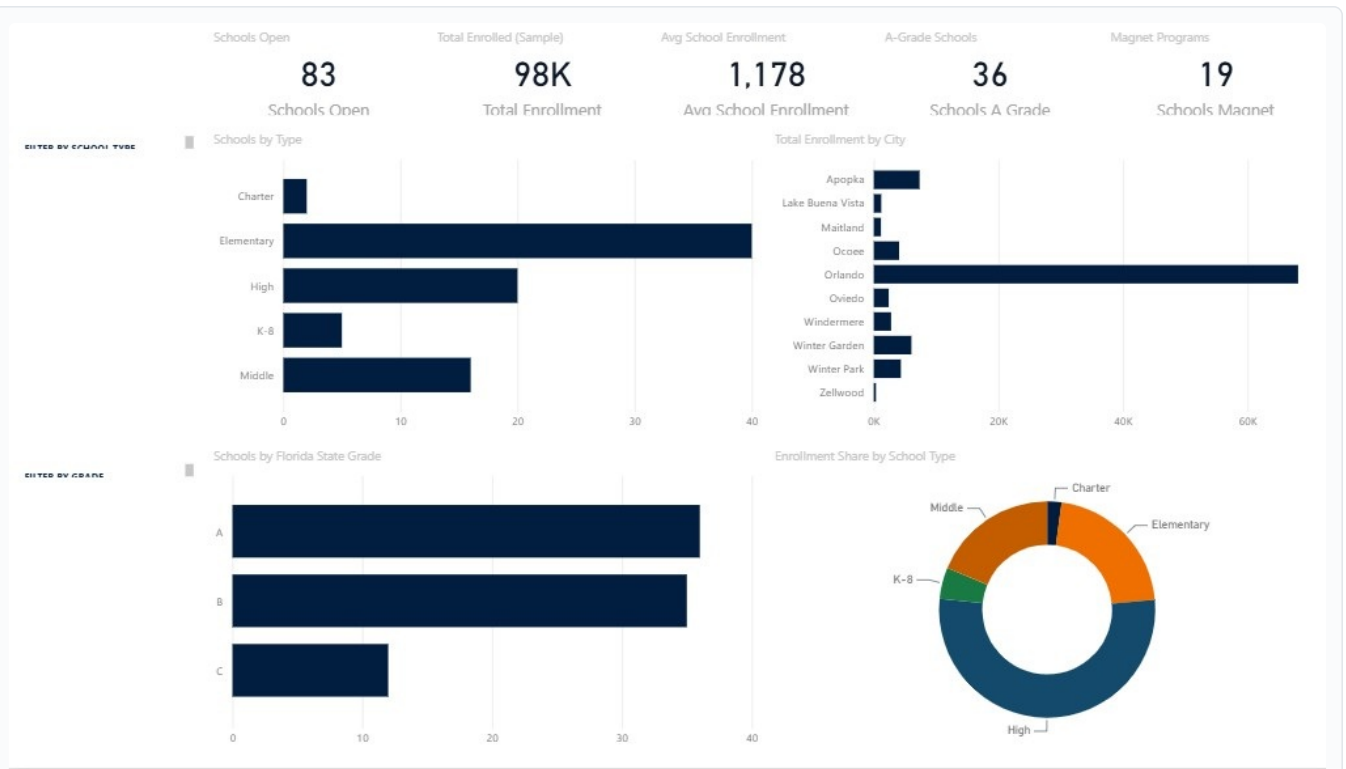
THE DISTRICT AT A GLANCE

207K students, 214 schools, 23K employees, and a \$3.8B budget, with a 92.7% graduation rate for 2024-25. The enrollment trend from 1869 to 2024 shows over a century of slow, gradual growth followed by a sharp acceleration from roughly the 1950s onward — mirroring the broader Central Florida population boom. Hispanic/Latino and economically disadvantaged students are the two largest demographic categories tracked. Instructional staff dominate the employee-category breakdown by a wide margin over school support, technology, administration, facilities, and food service combined.



THE SCHOOLS THEMSELVES

Of the sampled 83 schools (98K enrolled, averaging 1,178 students each), elementary schools are by far the most numerous school type (roughly 38), but high schools — despite being fewer in number (about 20) — claim the largest single share of total enrollment, reflecting their much larger average size. Orlando alone accounts for roughly 70% of the sampled enrollment across all other cities in the district combined. 36 of the sampled schools earned an A grade, and 19 magnet programs are tracked district-wide.



83 schools sampled, 98K enrolled — Orlando dominates enrollment by city; high schools claim the largest enrollment share despite fewer campuses than elementary.

ACADEMIC PROGRAMS: BREADTH VS. SCALE AREN'T THE SAME THING

34 active academic programs serve 92K students, including 7,800 dually enrolled and 10 IB programs, against a 59.5% overall FAST proficiency rate. Magnet programs have the most program-count variety (about 12 distinct offerings), but ESOL/multilingual services enroll the most students of any program type (roughly 32K) — more than Advanced Placement (about 25K) and far more than Gifted (about 13K) or Dual Enrollment (about 8K). Program variety and program enrollment scale point to different priorities entirely.

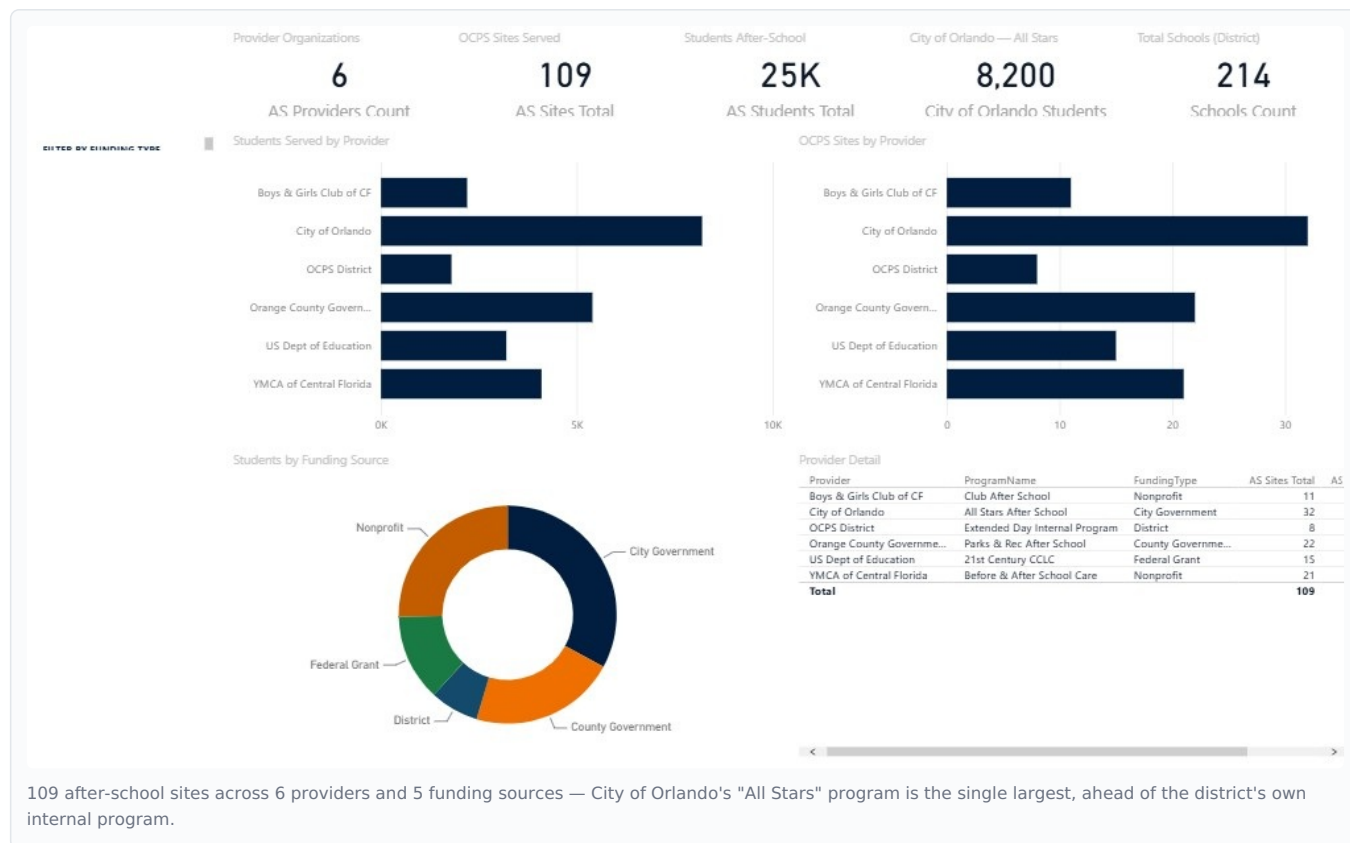


ESOL/multilingual enrollment (~32K) exceeds Advanced Placement (~25K) — the largest-enrollment program isn't the most commonly offered one (Magnet, ~12 program variants).

THE AFTER-SCHOOL NETWORK: A MULTI-AGENCY SYSTEM INSIDE A SCHOOL DISTRICT

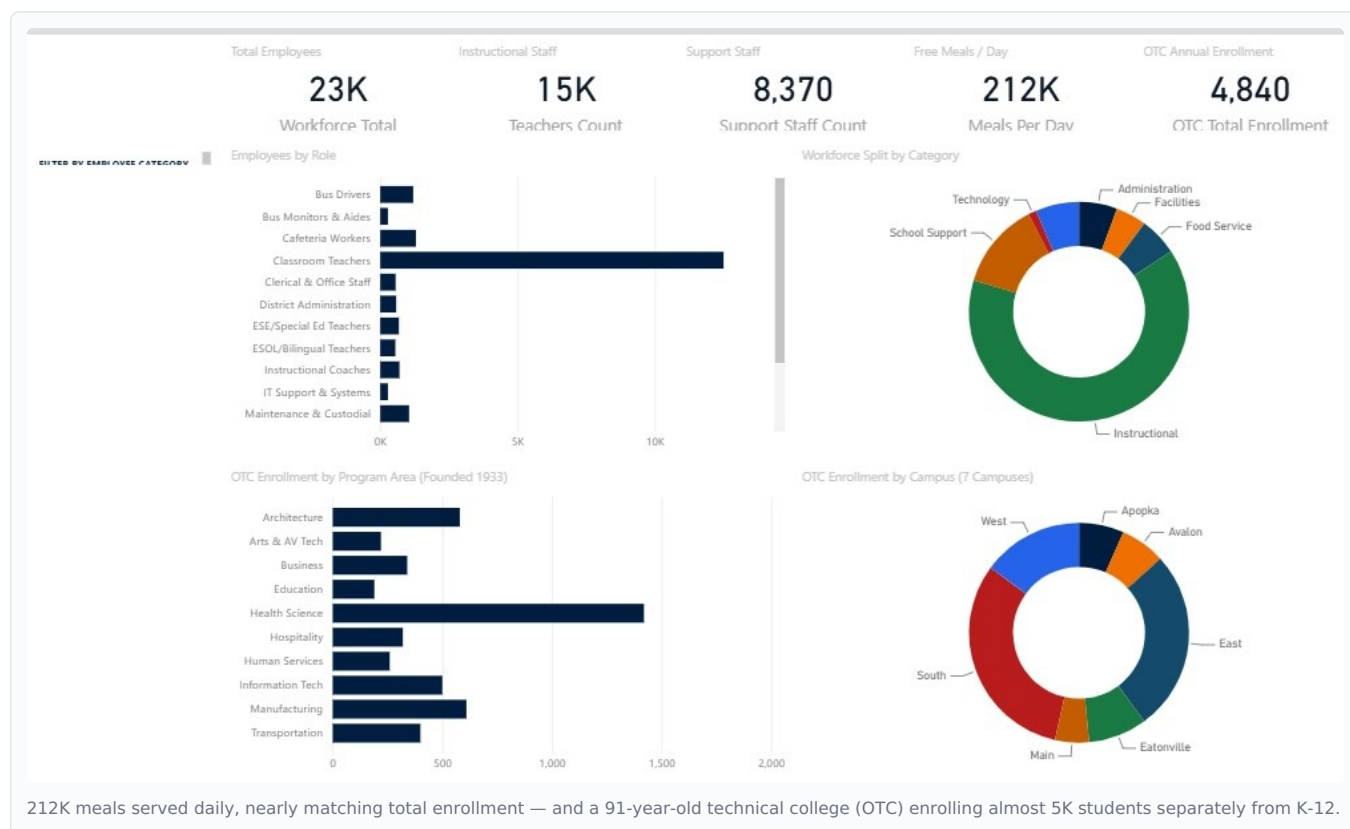
6 provider organizations run 109 after-school sites serving 25K students. The City of Orlando's "All Stars" program is the single largest provider by both students (8,200) and sites (32) — larger than the district's own internal Extended Day

program (8 sites). Funding spans five distinct sources: city government, county government, a federal 21st Century CCLC grant, and two different nonprofits (Boys & Girls Club, YMCA), alongside the district's own budget.



THE WORKFORCE BEHIND IT — AND A TECHNICAL COLLEGE MOST PEOPLE DON'T KNOW THE DISTRICT RUNS

23K total employees break down into 15K instructional staff and 8,370 support staff, with Classroom Teachers as the single largest role by far. The district serves roughly 212K meals per day — close to the total student enrollment figure, suggesting near-universal meal-program participation. Separately, Orlando Technical College (OTC, founded 1933 — decades before OCPS's own enrollment boom) enrolls 4,840 students annually across 7 campuses and 10 program areas, with Health Science the largest single area by a wide margin.



04 · Recommendations

The transferable takeaway

- **Resource allocation should follow enrollment concentration, not a flat per-school model** — with Orlando alone representing roughly 70% of sampled enrollment and high schools claiming outsized enrollment share despite fewer campuses, a uniform per-school funding approach would misallocate relative to where students actually are.
- **Treat ESOL as core infrastructure, not a supplemental program** — its ~32K enrollment exceeds Advanced Placement, making it the single largest-enrollment academic program in the district; staffing and budget should reflect that scale, not just its category label.
- **Track after-school funding-source diversity as a resilience metric** — spreading 109 sites across five distinct funding channels (city, county, federal, two nonprofits, and the district itself) reduces single-source dependency, but the multi-agency coordination itself is a hidden administrative cost worth measuring separately.
- **Use meals-served as a live need indicator** — 212K daily meals against 207K enrolled students suggests near-universal participation; tracked alongside the economically-disadvantaged demographic count, this is a more immediate signal of need than annual enrollment figures alone.
- **Let OTC's program mix inform upstream K-12 career pathways** — Health Science's outsized share of technical-college enrollment (nearly 3x the next largest program area) signals workforce demand that could shape which career-academy pathways get built earlier, in the high schools that feed into it.